

THE FRAME 2: THE VERDICT

TSU Film 9 — Release Phase 2, Film 3 — the "Captain America: The Winter Soldier" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: THE FRAME, a second time — still Arianna Cummings's, still run on her own terms per the acquisition settled in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md`, now discovering that the parent company protecting it has been quietly compromised from the inside for years.

Why a second THE FRAME fits the Winter Soldier slot exactly: Winter Soldier is about discovering the institution you trusted has been corrupted from within since before you ever joined it, a friend presumed lost turning out to be a weapon someone else built, and a villain who is trusted specifically because no one thought to distrust him. THE ROSTER absorbed THE FRAME in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md` on good terms, in good faith — which is exactly the kind of institutional trust this film is built to test. Evelyn Marchetti-Hale has sat on this franchise's boards since `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md`, "right roughly half the time," per her own bible entry — precisely the kind of person nobody thinks to suspect the other half of the time.

Who this film belongs to: Arianna Cummings and Marc-Anthony Bullock together — this is the first film since `scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md` to genuinely co-lead two founders, because the threat sits inside infrastructure they both depend on. **Jules Abernathy-Kim** (`TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md`, "The Press") gets her first real activation as the Sam Wilson position — an outside ally with her own expertise, not a founder, not for sale. **Benji Oyelaran-Cox** (`TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md`, "The Wildcards" — introduced as a nobody in Phase 1, built to "age up across the whole timeline in real time") fills the Bucky Barnes position: a presumed-vanished young technologist, quietly isolated and used for years by the very institution everyone trusted. Priya Ramasubramanian fills the Nick Fury position, including its central trick.

In-universe timeline: January 2014 – June 2014. Ages verified against `TSU_Core_Cast.md`: Marc-Anthony turns 32 on Jan 5; Arianna is 31 the entire film (turns 32 in October, after the story closes); Esther is 31, turning 32 in September.

LOGLINE

THE FRAME's discovery feed has started quietly burying creators before they've done anything wrong — and when Arianna Cummings and Marc-Anthony Bullock pull the thread, they find an algorithm running across every platform Evelyn Marchetti-Hale has ever sat on the board of, built to predict and preemptively silence "risk" before it happens, maintained for years by a brilliant young engineer everyone in this franchise assumed had simply disappeared.

SYNOPSIS

It's early 2014. Arianna Cummings notices something small first — a handful of THE FRAME creators, all promising, all suddenly invisible in the discovery feed for no reason anyone can find in the platform's own published rules. Marc-Anthony notices the same pattern at THE ROSTER a week later. Neither company's engineers can explain it. Something is deciding who gets seen before either platform's own systems ever weigh in.

Priya Ramasubramanian, quietly investigating a pattern of oddly-timed platform decisions across her entire portfolio for months, gets too close. Her car goes off a coastal road on the way home from a meeting nobody else knew she'd taken. The reports call it a serious accident. The prognosis is grim. The franchise's connective tissue since Film 1 — the corkboard, the meetings, the "I want them in one room" — goes dark overnight, and Arianna and Marc-Anthony are left with no one steering the bigger picture but themselves.

What they find, working together for the first time as genuine equals, is **THE VERDICT** — a predictive-suppression system running quietly beneath THE FRAME, THE ROSTER, and at least two other platforms, all of which share exactly one board member: **Evelyn Marchetti-Hale**. THE VERDICT doesn't moderate what's already happened. It predicts what a user is statistically likely to do or say next — based on financial stress signals, mental health flags, associations, sentiment trends — and suppresses them pre-emptively, silently, permanently, before they've done anything at all. Evelyn built it, over years, genuinely convinced she was protecting the industry and the public from the next scandal, the next harassment mob, the next Feed War, by removing the risk before it could metastasize. She is not wrong about the dangers she's seen up close for a decade. She is catastrophically wrong about the solution.

The system's actual technical backbone, it turns out, has been maintained for three years by **Benji Oyelaran-Cox** — the teenage prodigy who did uncredited early engineering work on THE FRAME itself back in `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`, and who everyone in this ensemble assumed had simply moved on to other work when they quietly stopped showing up. In reality, Evelyn found Benji isolated, financially desperate, and offered exactly the kind of validation and purpose a brilliant, overlooked young person is hardest to protect from — years of it, slowly, until Benji believed completely that THE VERDICT was necessary, protective work, not a censorship machine with no oversight and no appeal.

Working with journalist **Jules Abernathy-Kim** — the one byline every founder in this franchise checks first and dreads most, already circling rumors of THE VERDICT for months without a source willing to confirm it — Arianna and Marc-Anthony trace the system to a live rollout: Evelyn is about to expand THE VERDICT industry-wide, sold to the boards she sits on as "predictive trust and safety," on the same week as a major cross-platform transparency summit. Confronting Benji directly, rather than exposing them alongside Evelyn, is what actually breaks the case open — Benji, finally shown genuine, unconditional support instead of validation with strings attached, hands over the system's full architecture and its complete suppression logs.

At the summit, Arianna and Marc-Anthony expose THE VERDICT publicly, with Jules's reporting running in the same hour — and Priya, alive the entire time, quietly protected and hidden by Constance Abiodun-Mayhew while she gathered the financial trail connecting Evelyn's board seats, reveals herself on stage at exactly the moment Evelyn insists there's no proof. THE ROSTER, THE FRAME, and every platform Evelyn touched commit publicly to independent oversight and a real appeals process. Evelyn is removed from every board she sits on and referred to Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee. Benji is not

prosecuted — rehabilitated, publicly credited for coming forward, and quietly welcomed back into the ensemble's orbit rather than discarded, the same mercy this franchise has extended to every genuinely remorseful person it's put through the wringer.

THE ANTAGONISTS

Per the Villains Bench rules (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §5), the real cause traces to a person's decision, made with the sincere belief it was protective.

1. **EVELYN MARCHETTI-HALE**, escalated from her recurring role since `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md` (the Alexander Pierce analog) — genuinely convinced THE VERDICT protects the industry from harm she's watched up close for a decade. Not a mustache-twirler; the single most dangerous kind of villain this franchise has produced, because she is right about the danger and catastrophically wrong about the cure.
2. **THE VERDICT**, THE ENGINE's ninth and most totalizing manifestation yet — not reactive moderation, predictive suppression: judgment rendered before an act occurs, with no appeal and no visibility, the clearest possible argument yet for why an algorithm can never be trusted with unaccountable power.
3. **BENJI OYELARAN-COX** (*the Bucky Barnes analog, not a villain*) — a genuinely brilliant, genuinely overlooked young technologist, isolated and slowly convinced rather than coerced by force. The film's insistence on rehabilitation over prosecution is deliberate: Benji was a weapon someone else built, the same way Teddy Ashcombe-Vance's bible entry always specified corrosion "grown there rather than planted."

HOW THIS FILM CONTINUES RELEASE PHASE 2

- **A recurring gatekeeper's ambiguity, finally cashed in as real danger:** Evelyn Marchetti-Hale's bible entry always said she was "right roughly half the time" — this film is what the other half looks like at scale.
 - **A long-dormant Wildcard activated exactly as designed:** Benji Oyelaran-Cox's entire purpose per `TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md` was to "age up across the whole timeline in real time" and eventually become "quietly indispensable" — this is the film where that indispensability turns out to have a cost nobody was watching for.
 - **The Press, finally load-bearing:** Jules Abernathy-Kim's bible entry called her "an actual check on power" from the moment she was created — this is the first film to actually need one.
 - **Priya's Nick Fury role, played all the way through:** not just the connective corkboard, but the fake-out at the center of the source film — she was never actually gone, and the ensemble (and audience) believing otherwise is the point.
 - **Institutional consequence at real scale:** for the first time, a villain's fall changes how every platform in the franchise operates going forward, not just one company.
-

FORMAT (per `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, Corporate/Legal Thriller	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed — a serious accident (off-screen/hospital aftermath) and mass-surveillance themes, nothing that pushes past it
Runtime	130–150 min	136 min
Page count	120–140 pages	133 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–34
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 35–101
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 102–133
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	48 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–34 ("Nobody Decided This")

#	Scene	pp.
1	INT. THE FRAME — DAY, JAN 2014 — Arianna notices promising creators quietly vanishing from discovery, no rule broken	1–4
2	INT. THE ROSTER — DAY — Marc-Anthony notices the identical pattern, a week later, on a different platform	4–7
3	INT. PRIYA'S OFFICE — DAY — Priya, already quietly investigating, connects the two founders' reports to a pattern across her own portfolio	7–10

#	Scene	pp.
4	INT. THE FRAME — WAR ROOM — DAY — engineering confirms neither platform's own systems are making these calls	10–13
5	EXT. COASTAL ROAD — NIGHT — Priya's car goes off the road. Inciting incident.	13–16
6	INT. HOSPITAL — NIGHT — the ensemble gathers; the prognosis is grim; the corkboard goes dark	16–20
7	INT. MARC-ANTHONY'S OFFICE — DAY — Marc-Anthony and Arianna, forced into the same investigation, uneasy but necessary partnership	20–23
8	INT. JULES ABERNATHY-KIM'S OFFICE (CAMEO INTRO) — DAY — Jules, already circling rumors of a predictive system, still without a confirmable source	23–27
9	INT. THE FRAME — WAR ROOM — DAY — the trail across platforms narrows to one shared name: Evelyn Marchetti-Hale	27–30
10	INT. MARC-ANTHONY'S OFFICE — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony and Arianna decide to investigate Evelyn directly, off the record. Act I turn.	30–34

ACT II — pp. 35–101 ("The Verdict")

#	Scene	pp.
11	MONTAGE — THE INVESTIGATION — Arianna, Marc-Anthony, and Jules, tracing THE VERDICT's infrastructure across four companies	35–39

#	Scene	pp.
12	INT. CONSTANCE ABIODUN-MAYHEW'S OFFICE — DAY — Constance, guarded, reveals just enough to confirm Priya is alive and hidden	39–43
13	INT. SAFE HOUSE — NIGHT — Priya, recovering, feeding the investigation from hiding — the Nick Fury trick, played straight	43–47
14	INT. EVELYN MARCHETTI-HALE'S OFFICE (CAMEO) — DAY — a courtesy meeting; Evelyn is composed, gracious, and gives away nothing	47–50
15	EXT. LOS ANGELES — NIGHT — Jules's own sources start going quiet, unnervingly, all at once	50–53
16	INT. THE FRAME — WAR ROOM — DAY — the technical trail leads to a single maintainer account, active for three years, name redacted	53–57
17	INT. MALCOLM'S STUDIO — NIGHT — Malcolm and Arianna; the personal cost of chasing an institutional threat instead of running her company	57–60
18	INT. SAFE HOUSE — NIGHT — Priya unmask the redacted account: Benji Oyelaran-Cox. Midpoint.	60–64
19	EXT. BENJI'S APARTMENT — DAY — Arianna and Marc-Anthony find Benji, older, isolated, guarded in a way nobody who knew them as a teenager would recognize	64–68
20	INT. BENJI'S APARTMENT — CONTINUOUS — Benji's story: found by Evelyn at a low point, given purpose, told for years it was protective work	68–73

#	Scene	pp.
21	INT. BENJI'S APARTMENT — CONTINUOUS — Marc-Anthony, recognizing the shape of it immediately: "This is what happened to Teddy. This is what happens to everyone she finds first."	73–76
22	INT. EVELYN'S OFFICE — DAY — Evelyn, sensing the net closing, accelerates THE VERDICT's industry-wide rollout	76–80
23	INT. THE ROSTER — BOARDROOM — DAY — Evelyn pitches the expansion to the full board as "predictive trust and safety," gracious and convincing	80–84
24	EXT. BENJI'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Arianna and Marc-Anthony, not exposing Benji, offering something instead: help, without strings	84–88
25	INT. BENJI'S APARTMENT — CONTINUOUS — Benji, finally offered support with no conditions attached, decides to hand over the architecture	88–92
26	INT. SAFE HOUSE — NIGHT — Priya's financial trail completes: every one of Evelyn's board seats, one shared line of funding	92–96
27	INT. JULES'S OFFICE — DAY — the story is ready; the plan becomes a coordinated public exposure at the transparency summit	96–99
28	INT. THE FRAME — WAR ROOM — NIGHT — final preparations; Priya's condition for helping: she reveals herself only once, on her own terms. Closes Act II.	99–101

ACT III — pp. 102–133 ("Nobody Gets to Decide Alone")

#	Scene	pp.
29	EXT. TRANSPARENCY SUMMIT — DAY — arrival; Evelyn on stage, mid-pitch for THE VERDICT's industry-wide adoption	102–105
30	INT. SUMMIT — MAIN STAGE — Arianna and Marc-Anthony interrupt, Benji's architecture and logs in hand. Climax begins.	105–109
31	INT. SUMMIT — MAIN STAGE, CONTINUOUS — Jules's exposé goes live in the same minute, cross-referenced, undeniable	109–113
32	INT. SUMMIT — MAIN STAGE, CONTINUOUS — Evelyn, composed to the end, insists there's no proof connecting her directly	113–115
33	INT. SUMMIT — CONTINUOUS — Priya walks onto the stage, alive, with the financial trail in hand. The reveal.	115–119
34	INSERT — THE VERDICT — the system taken offline across every connected platform within the hour	119–121
35	INT. SENATE COMMITTEE OFFICES (CAMEO) — DAY — Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee opens a formal inquiry into Evelyn	121–124
36	INT. THE ROSTER — BOARDROOM — DAY — Evelyn removed from every board she sits on; independent oversight and an appeals process announced across all four platforms	124–127
37	EXT. BENJI'S APARTMENT — DAY — Benji, publicly credited for coming forward, not prosecuted — welcomed, carefully, back into the wider ensemble's orbit	127–130

#	Scene	pp.
38	STINGER — INT. HOSPITAL / SAFE HOUSE — DAY — Priya, recovering fully, already looking at a new set of names on a fresh corkboard	130–133

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the full shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 48 per the house-style table above.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE FRAME 2: THE VERDICT

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

INT. THE FRAME — DAY

SUPER: "JANUARY 2014"

ARIANNA CUMMINGS, 31, scrolls through a spreadsheet of creator metrics, frowning. MALCOLM PIERCE looks over her shoulder.

ARIANNA

These four accounts had real traction two weeks ago. Now they're not showing up in discovery at all. No strikes. No reports. Nothing in the moderation log.

MALCOLM

Maybe the algorithm's just noisy this week.

ARIANNA

(not looking up)
I built this algorithm, Malcolm. It doesn't get noisy. Somebody, or something, decided these four people shouldn't be seen, and nobody wrote that decision down anywhere I can find it.

CUT TO:

EXT. COASTAL ROAD — NIGHT

[inciting incident, p. 13]

PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN drives alone, phone on speaker, mid-call.

PRIYA

(into phone)

– I need everything you have on Marchetti-Hale's fund structure, all four platforms, by tomorrow. Something isn't –

The car's brakes give out on a curve with no warning at all. We do not see the impact. We hear it, once, and then the sound of the ocean, and then nothing.

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. BENJI'S APARTMENT – CONTINUOUS

[p. 73]

BENJI OYELARAN-COX, early 20s now, they/them, sits across from MARC-ANTHONY and ARIANNA in a sparse, carefully controlled apartment – nothing personal on the walls, everything purposeful.

BENJI

She found me when I had four hundred dollars and nowhere to be. She didn't ask me to build a weapon. She asked me to build something that stops the next Feed War before it starts. I believed her for three years because believing her was the first time in my life anyone told me my work actually mattered enough to protect people with.

MARC-ANTHONY

(quiet, and something in his face changes)
This is what happened to Teddy.

ARIANNA

Marc –

MARC-ANTHONY

No, I mean it exactly. This is what happens to everyone she finds first. She doesn't recruit people who are already corrupted. She finds people who are brilliant and overlooked and gives them the one thing nobody else offered them, and by the time they realize what they actually built, they've already spent years believing it was the good thing.

BENJI

(very still)
Is it not the good thing?

ARIANNA

(gently, the whole point of the scene)
It silences people before they've done anything. There's no appeal. There's no way to know you've been judged, let alone argue you were judged wrong. That's not protection, Benji. That's a verdict with no trial.

A long silence. Something in Benji's carefully controlled face finally cracks.

CUT TO:

INT. SUMMIT – CONTINUOUS

[climax, p. 115]

EVELYN MARCHETTI-HALE, composed, unhurried, faces down a room that has just watched its own trust collapse in real time.

EVELYN

Show me one document with my name directly authorizing any specific suppression. One. Everything you've shown this room is architecture and inference.

A beat. Then, from the back of the room, unannounced –

PRIYA (O.S.)

I have four years of fund transfers that do the job instead.

The room turns. PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN walks down the center aisle, thinner, a faint scar at her hairline, entirely, undeniably alive. Gasps ripple through the crowd – this is the first time most of this room has seen her since the accident four months ago.

EVELYN

(the first genuine crack in her composure this entire film)
You're supposed to be –

PRIYA

I know what I'm supposed to be. I've had four months to let you believe it while I finished tracing exactly which of your board seats funded which line item of THE VERDICT's development. It's all here. It's all admissible. And it's all published as of ninety seconds ago, alongside Jules Abernathy-Kim's story.

Evelyn has no next sentence ready. For the first time in this franchise, that silence belongs entirely to her.

CUT TO:

STINGER

INT. HOSPITAL / SAFE HOUSE – DAY

PRIYA, in a hospital bed, recovering, very much alive, reviews a folder on a laptop propped against her knees. The old corkboard photo sits on a side table nearby.

Her assistant enters with a new folder.

ASSISTANT

The board wants to know when you're coming back.

PRIYA

(not looking up from the laptop)
Tell them soon. Tell them I found something interesting while I was supposed to be resting.

ASSISTANT

What is it?

Priya turns the laptop around. A map, international, several countries highlighted – European regulatory filings, a name we haven't heard yet circled in red: Chioma Asante-Reyes.

PRIYA

Turns out this industry's problems stopped being just an American conversation a while ago. Somebody should probably go find out how far behind we actually are.

FADE OUT.

THE END.

[133.]